



✦ TRAVEL GUIDE 2026

New Jersey Comprehensive Travel Plan

A handcrafted 4-day journey across the Garden State — from the Manhattan skyline to the Victorian shore. Every recommendation tested for an authentic experience.

□ 4 Days / 3 Nights

□ Newark ↔ Cape May

□ Budget: \$860–\$1,820 pp

□ Mid-Range · First-Timer



Trip Profile

- ▶ **Duration:** 4 days / 3 nights
- ▶ **Route:** Newark → Hoboken/JC → Princeton → Shore → Buffer day
- ▶ **Best for:** First-time NJ visitors wanting a balanced mix
- ▶ **Pace:** Moderate — one main activity per half-day
- ▶ **Transport:** NJ Transit + 1 rental car day (shore)
- ▶ **Season:** May-Oct ideal; plan works year-round

Budget Breakdown

CATEGORY	LOW	HIGH
Hotel (3 nights)	\$420	\$840
Food (4 days)	\$220	\$480
Transit	\$60	\$140
Rental car (2 days)	\$140	\$280
Attractions	\$20	\$80
Total (per person)	\$860	\$1,820

Best Seasons

- ▶ **May-Jun** — Perfect weather, gardens blooming, fewer crowds
- ▶ *** Jul-Aug** — Peak beach, hotter, busier, book ahead
- ▶ **Sep-Oct** — Best shore, foliage, mild days, lower rates
- ▶ *** Nov-Feb** — Great for indoor dining, culture, museums

Travel Times

ROUTE	TIME	MODE
Newark → Hoboken	15 min	Train
Hoboken → Princeton Jct	50 min	Train
Princeton → Cape May	2 hr	Car
Princeton → AC	1.5 hr	Car
Newark → Manhattan	20 min	PATH

Cape May

- Best for:** Victorian charm, shore ending
- Price:** \$180-\$350/night (book 3+ weeks ahead)
- Recommendations:**
- ▶ Congress Hall — historic beachfront resort
 - ▶ The Virginia Hotel — boutique, adult-focused
 - ▶ Birch Bed & Breakfast — cozy B&B

Asbury Park

- Best for:** Music scene, boardwalk energy
- Price:** \$130-\$250/night
- Recommendations:**
- ▶ Asbury Ocean Club — modern luxury
 - ▶ The Asbury Hotel — rooftop bar, central
 - ▶ Berkeley Oceanfront Hotel — budget option

Reservation Tips

- Book Cape May at least 3 weeks ahead for summer weekends
- Hoboken hotels fill up for NYC events; check local calendars
- Midweek (Mon-Thu) rates are often 30-40% lower
- Use Booking.com or Expedia; call B&Bs directly for better rates
- Ask about parking fees — some hotels charge \$25-50/night
- Check-in: standard is 3-4pm; early check-in rare on weekends

☐ Top 5 Experiences

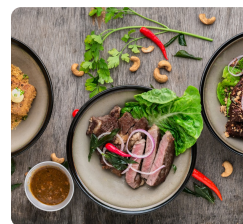
- ▶ Manhattan skyline from Hoboken waterfront at sunset
- ▶ Princeton University + Grounds For Sculpture
- ▶ Cape May Victorian architecture & lighthouse climb
- ▶ Razza pizza in Jersey City (ranked among US best)
- ▶ Asbury Park boardwalk & music history

02

Day-by-Day Itinerary

05

Food & Dining Guide



☐ Must-Try Restaurants

- ▶ **Razza**
(Jersey City)
— wood-fired pizza, rated among US top 10
- ▶ **Lobster House**
(Cape May)
— dock-side seafood, must-try lobster
- ▶ **Triumph Brewing**
(Princeton)
— brewpub with excellent food
- ▶ **White House Subs**
(AC) — iconic Italian sub since 1946
- ▶ **Stage Left**
(New Brunswick)
— upscale American, wine list
- ▶ **Zeppelin Hall** (JC) — massive beer garden, 60+ taps

Day 01

▯ HOBOKEN ·
JERSEY CITY

The Skyline Arrival

▯ Skyline

▯ Walk

▯ Pizza

▯ Photo

* **Morning:**

Arrive at Newark Penn Station. Grab coffee + pastry at **Choc o Pain** or **Bwe Café** (Hoboken). Walk Washington Street — boutiques, brownstones, and cafés.

▯ **Afternoon:**

Hoboken waterfront path. The Manhattan skyline from Pier A is the best free view in the state.

Photo stop: Sinatra Drive at 3pm for golden light.

▯ **Evening:**

Liberty State Park for sunset behind the Statue of Liberty.
Dinner: Razza (Jersey City) — their margherita is legendary. Reserve ahead.

Day 02

▯ PRINCETON
· NEW
BRUNSWICK

Ivy League & Sculpture Gardens

▯ History

▯ Art

▯ Brewery

▯ Garden

* **Morning:**

Train to Princeton Junction, shuttle to Princeton campus. Walk Nassau Hall, Palmer Square, and the **Princeton University Art Museum** (free, world-class collection).

▯

Afternoon:

Grounds For Sculpture in Hamilton — 42 acres of outdoor sculpture. Allow 2–3 hours. Book tickets online.

▯ **Evening:**

New Brunswick on the Rutgers campus edge.
Dinner: Stage Left Steak or a casual option at **Triumph Brewing**. Two local

☕ Cafés & Bakeries

- ▶ **Bwe Café** (Hoboken) — artisan coffee, quiet workspace
- ▶ **Choc o Pain** (Hoboken) — French pastries, croissants
- ▶ **Small World Coffee** (Princeton) — local institution
- ▶ **The Bent Spoon** (Hoboken) — artisan ice cream
- ▶ **Fins** (Cape May) — homemade fudge, salt water taffy

☐ Day 1 Quick Picks

- ▶ ☕ **Breakfast:**
Bwe Café,
1025
Maxwell
Ln,
Hoboken
- ▶ ☐ **Dinner:**
Razza Pizza
Artigianale,
275 Grove
St, JC
- ▶ ☐ **Drinks:**
Zeppelin
Hall Beer
Garden, 88
Liberty
View Dr, JC
- ▶ ☐ **Late:**
Exchange
Place
waterfront
for lit NYC
skyline

breweries
within
walking
distance.

☐ Day 2 Quick Picks

- ▶ ☐ **Lunch:**
Hoagie
Haven
(iconic
Princeton
subs) or
Jammin'
Crêpes
- ▶ ☐ **Art:**
Grounds
For
Sculpture
— \$25
adults,
\$18
students
- ▶ ☐ **Brewery:**
Triumph
Brewing,
138
Nassau
St,
Princeton
- ▶ ☐ **Dinner**
NB: Frog
and the
Peach, 29
Dennis
St, NB

03

Day-by-Day Itinerary (cont.)

Day 03

▢ CAPE MAY /
ATLANTIC
CITY

Coastal Escape — Choose Your Shore

▢ Beach

▢ Seafood

▢ Photo

▢ Shopping

▢ **Get there:**

Rent a car in Princeton/
New Brunswick.
For Cape May, take the Garden State Parkway south (2 hrs). For AC, it's 1.5 hrs.

▢ **Cape May option:**

Victorian B&B district, Washington Street Mall, Cape May Lighthouse (199 steps for panoramic views). Sunset Beach for the famous flag ceremony.

Dinner:

Lobster House (dock-side) or Tisha's for upscale.

▢ **AC option:**

Boardwalk, Steel Pier, casino hopping, people-watching. Faster access,

Day 04

▢ FLEXIBLE
BUFFER

Your Choice — Three Directions

▢ Music

▢ Art

☕ Café

▢ Vintage

▢ **Asbury**

Park: Iconic music history — The Stone Pony, Asbury Lanes.

Vintage shopping on Cookman Ave.

Boardwalk with street art and the Paramount Theatre.

Great brunch spots (Toast, Porch).

▢ **Montclair:**

Montclair Art Museum, Van Vleck Gardens, charming downtown with indie bookstores and farm-to-table dining. Calm, cultured, easy.

▢ **Jersey City**

(relax): Hit the restaurants you missed on Day 1. Explore the Indian Square (Newark Ave) for dosas and chaat. Grove

cheaper hotels, but less charm.
Food: Dock's Oyster House (classic) or White House Subs.

Street PATH area for people-watching.

Shore Comparison

FACTOR	CAPE MAY	ATLANTIC CITY
Vibe	Romantic, Victorian, quiet	Energetic, boardwalk, casino
Beach Quality	★★★★ Clean, wide	★★★★ Good, crowded
Nightlife	Quiet pubs, sunset bars	Clubs, shows, 24/7
Best For	Couples, families, photographers	Groups, gamblers, night owls
Parking	Limited, can be expensive	Abundant, casino validation
Drive from Princeton	2 hrs	1.5 hrs

04 Where to Stay



▣ Hoboken / Jersey City

Best for: Skyline views, NYC access, walkability

Price: \$160-\$280/night

Recommendations:

- ▶ W Hoboken — luxury waterfront, superb views
- ▶ Canopy Jersey City — modern, close to Grove St PATH
- ▶ Hilton Garden Inn Hoboken — reliable mid-range

▣ Princeton

Best for: Quiet historic base, walkable campus

Price: \$140-\$220/night

Recommendations:

- ▶ Nassau Inn — iconic downtown location
- ▶ Hyatt Regency Princeton — near train station
- ▶ Peacock Inn — boutique, romantic